

State Machines: Making Work Observable

What exactly must be true before work advances?

06

**EVIDENCE
CONTRACTS
STATE
HUMAN AUTHORITY**

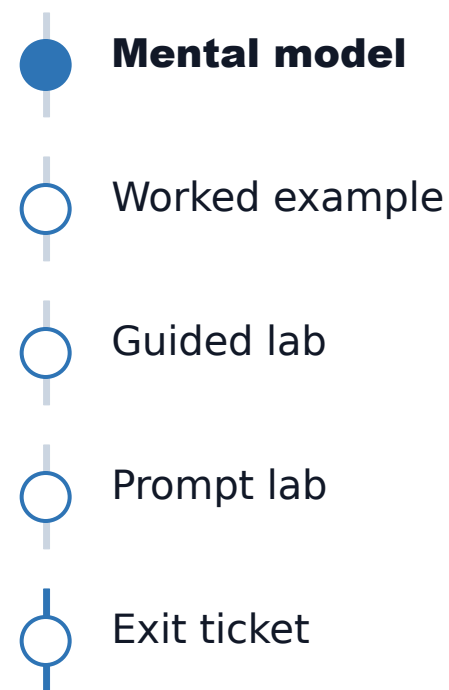
By the end, learners can do three observable things

01 **Model states, events, transitions, and guards**

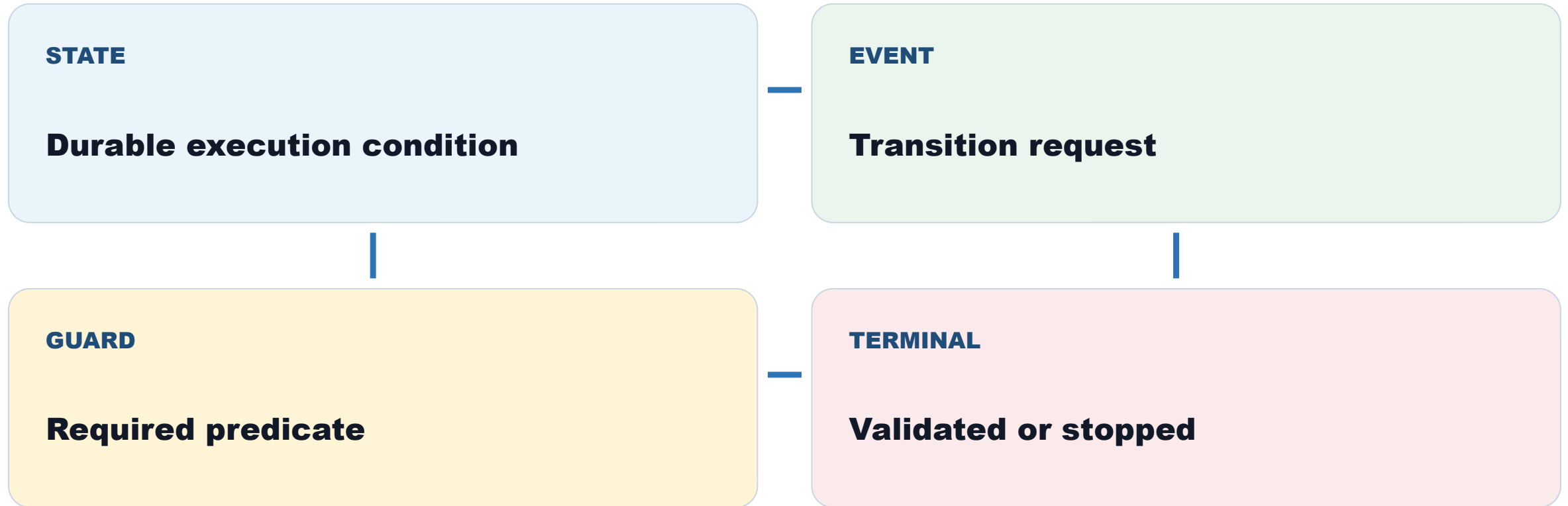
02 **Distinguish incomplete input, failure, and supersession**

03 **Design deterministic transitions**

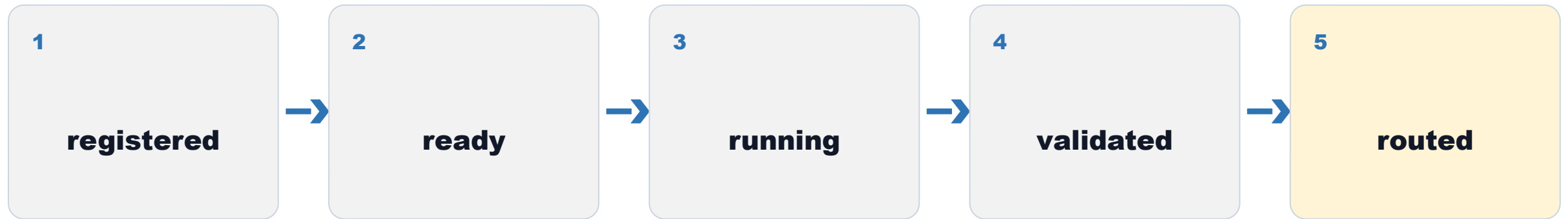
RUN OF SHOW



One system, four distinct ideas



A trustworthy result is a chain—not a clever paragraph



Failure branches: `incomplete_input` • `failed` • `superseded`

Build an artifact the room can inspect

TEAM TASK

Run a tabletop execution; transition only when every guard passes.

1

Draw event

2

Evaluate guard

3

Log transition

Suggested timing: 5 min brief • 20 min work • 10 min critique • 5 min repair

Turn the contract into executable prompt behavior

Specify safe incomplete-input behavior with no guessing.

01

Ready guard

02

Missing evidence

03

State output

04

Retry rule

05

Failure reason

06

Next action

Explain the difference between an event and a guard, then model two failure paths.

Answer with evidence. Name the contract, state, or authority boundary you used.